

Arizona Baseball Team Must Beat UTEP To Stay In Race

By DAVE KELLOGG
Star Staff Writer

EL PASO, Tex. — It's been said that winning isn't everything. It's the only thing!

For Jerry Kindall and his Wildcat baseball team, winning is all that is left as they enter another crucial Southern Division Western Athletic Conference series today, this time against the Miners of Texas-El Paso.

By losing a three-game series to division leader Arizona State (6-0) at the start of conference play, today's 1 p.m. game and Satur-

day's doubleheader against UTEP (2-4) are must-win situations for the Wildcats (3-3).

"We have to win the rest of our games in order to contend for the championship," Kindall said. "I can't expect Arizona State to lose, so our only chance is to keep winning . . . our season hinges on each game."

Dave Breuker (4-4) will carry the burden for Arizona today against either Bob Knox (3-0) or Ray Greggerson (3-1).

Breuker, a right-handed senior out of Amphi High School, has a 3.61 earned run aver-

age, allowing 49 hits in 57 and two-thirds innings while striking out 45.

Knox is the Miner's leading hurler with a perfect ERA after 30 and two-thirds innings, giving up 14 hits and fanning 22 batters. Greggerson has pitched 42 and two-thirds innings allowing 53 hits for a 2.98 ERA and has struck out 13.

Texas coach Andy Cohen contends his team is "raring to go" against the Wildcats despite being "annihilated by Arizona State" last week.

"We hope to make a respectable showing against Arizona's fine team," Cohen said. "Our pitching is not quite as strong as I thought it would be at season's start, but we hope to give Arizona a good game."

Cohen's mound woes are attested not only by their 17-14 overall record, but also by the fact the Miner pitching staff has given up 225 hits for 141 runs (92 earned) for a 3.33 team ERA.

By comparison, UTEP collected only 222 hits for 144 runs (102 earned) for a 3.84 ERA.

Pitching problems have also plagued the Wildcats, in what Kindall describes as "inconsistent performances."

Arizona's staff has given up 309 hits for 160 runs (137 earned) for a 3.60 team ERA. The 26-14 overall record can be attributed to Wildcat hitting which has amassed 252 runs (196 earned) on 384 hits for a 5.31 ERA.

Adding to Kindall's concern for this series is Joel Godfrey (7-1), Saturday's scheduled first-game starter, will not make the trip because of illness. Ed Anderson (3-1) will pitch instead with Mark Schimpf (4-1) throwing in the final contest of the series.

Although Kindall did not name his starting lineup, it is expected that he will start Marty Reid (.311) behind the plate, Bob Starke (.318) at first; Rudy Mendoza (.309) at second; Ben Heise (.319) at shortstop; either Bob Szczcinski (.273) or Bob Allen (.237) at third; Jim Filippelli (.294) in left field; Marv Thompson (.322) in center; Scott Norris (.226) in right; and either Allen or Rod Fleming (.362) as the designated hitter.

Arizona holds a 21-3 advantage over UTEP since the two started playing WAC games in 1969. The Wildcats swept both three-games series last year.

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